

Fish and Wildlife Supported by the Gulf of Mexico



Nick Wiley, Executive Director
June 1, 2011

The Gulf Ecosystem

- One of the world's most productive
- Hundreds of fish and wildlife species
- Economic engine
- Unique habitats
- Storm protection



The Gulf's Diverse Coastal Habitats



Beach/Surf Zone



Seagrass Beds



Estuary



Saltmarsh &
Oyster Reefs



Mangrove Swamp



Coral Reef



Gulf Coast Bird Life



American Oystercatcher

- The Florida Gulf Coast contains over 90% of the remaining healthy oyster reef habitat in the world and the second largest winter population of American Oystercatchers.



Red Knot

- Florida winter resident – breeds in the arctic
- Undertake one of the longest migrations of any animal (>9000 miles one way)
- Key roosting and foraging sites on the Florida Gulf Coast.



Sea Turtles and Marine Mammals

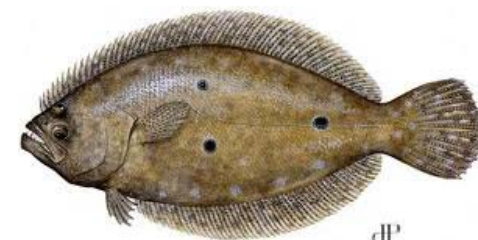
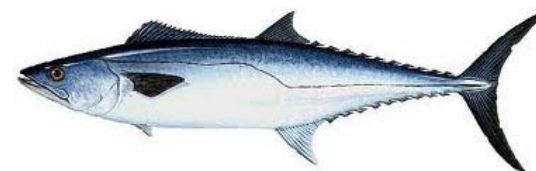
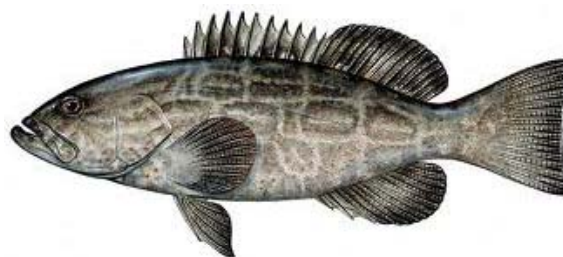
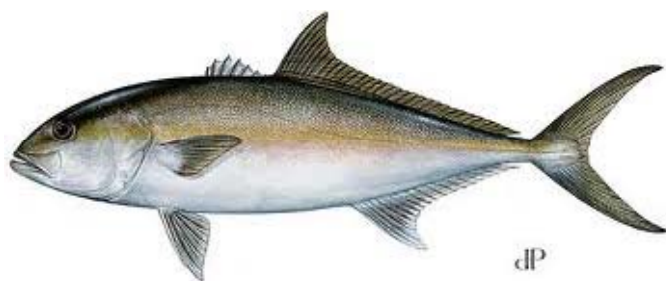
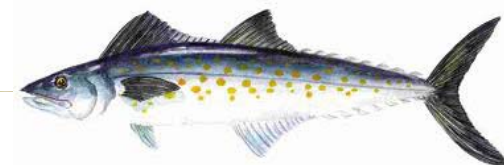
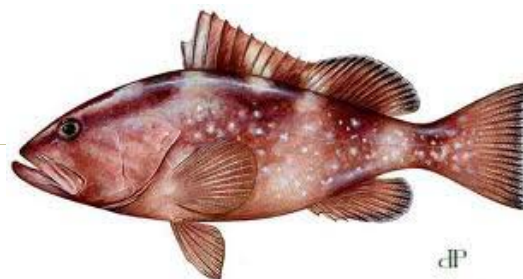
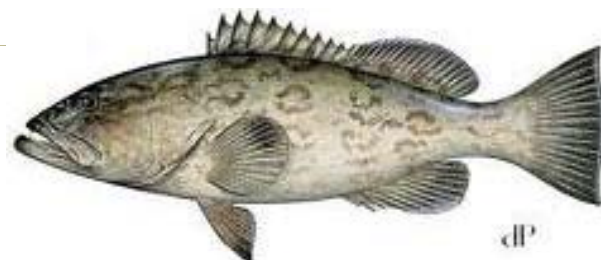
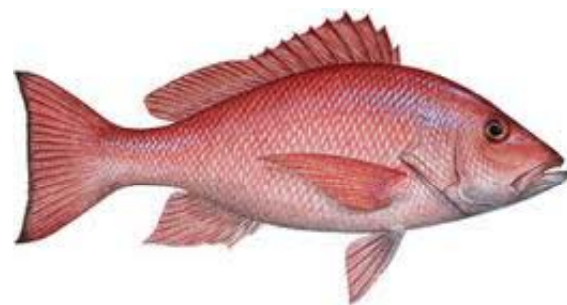


Sea Turtle Nesting - 2010

642 total nests (Fl Panhandle)
240 nests relocated
7000 hatchlings released

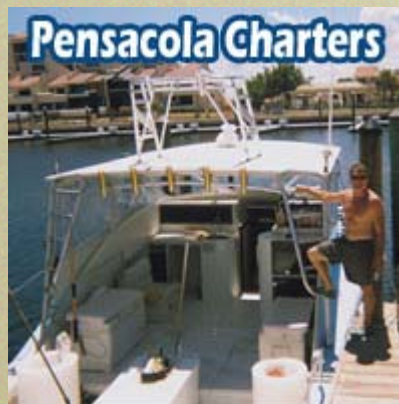


Incredible Gulf Fisheries



Recreational Saltwater Fishing

- More saltwater anglers than any other state
- Over 14 million trips in 2010 on the Gulf
- Robust charter fishing industry
- Extensive shore based infrastructure



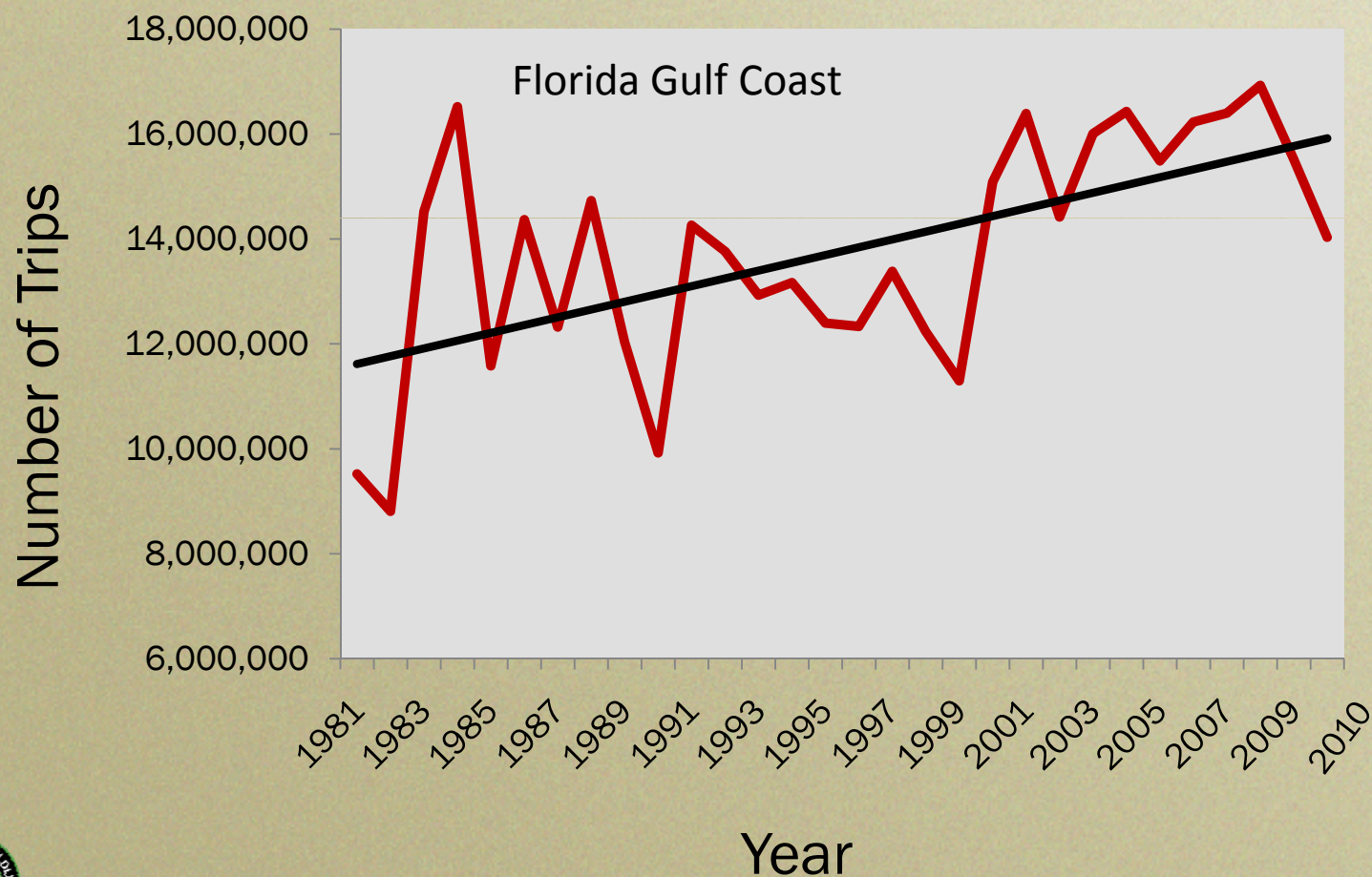
Offshore Game Fish



Inshore Game Fish



Trends in Recreational Fishing Effort



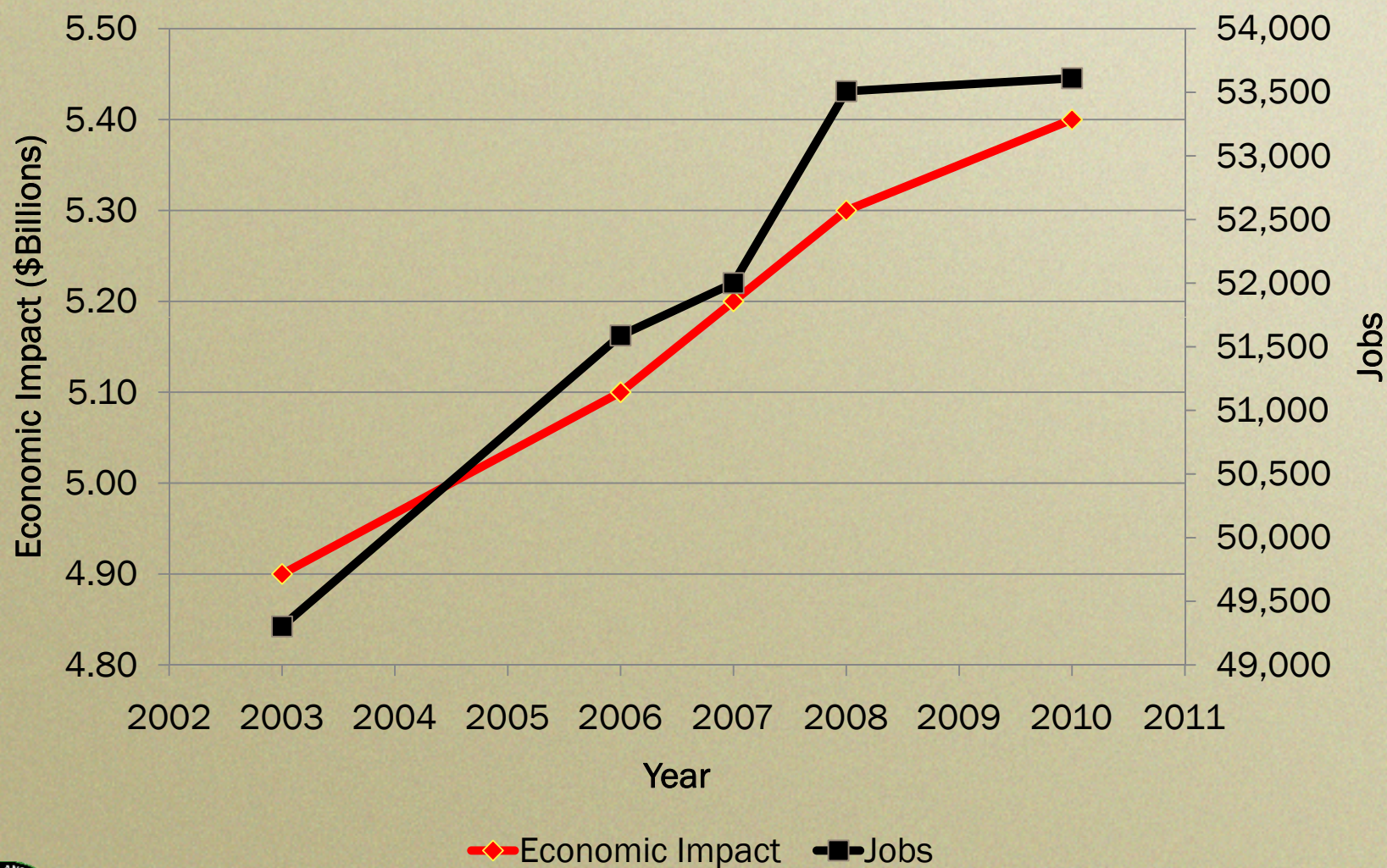
Fish and Wildlife Economic Impact Statewide



Category	Economic Impact	Jobs
Boating Industry	\$16,800,000,000	203,000
Saltwater Rec. Fishing	\$5,499,000,000	54,500
Wildlife Viewing	\$5,688,000,000	51,400
TOTAL	\$27,987,000,000	308,900



Saltwater Fishing Economic Impact Trend (FL)



Commercial Fishing

Top Ten

Value

- | | |
|----------------------|--------------|
| • Stone Crab (claws) | \$23 million |
| • Spiny Lobster | \$20 million |
| • Pink Shrimp | \$18 million |
| • Red Grouper | \$13 million |
| • Gag Grouper | \$ 5 million |
| • Blue Crab | \$ 5 million |
| • Bait Shrimp | \$ 5 million |
| • Black Mullet | \$ 4 million |
| • Oysters | \$ 4 million |
| • Brown Shrimp | \$ 3 million |





2008 Sales Impacts of the Florida Seafood Industry



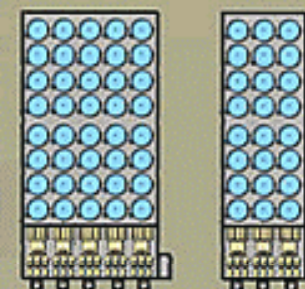
	Sales	Jobs
Commercial Harvesters	\$ 171,385,000	3,000
Seafood Processors & Dealers	\$ 423,923,000	4,000
Seafood Wholesalers & Distributors	\$ 1,272,539,000	11,700
Retail Sector	\$ 3,789,399,000	90,000
Total	\$ 5,657,246,000	108,700





Florida's Marine Fisheries Enhancement Initiative

- Proposed network of fisheries enhancement centers
- Recirculating aquaculture technology for fish production
- Replenishment of native stocks; boost resilience of fisheries
- Compliment ecosystem/habitat restoration efforts
- Bolster and sustain local fishery based economy



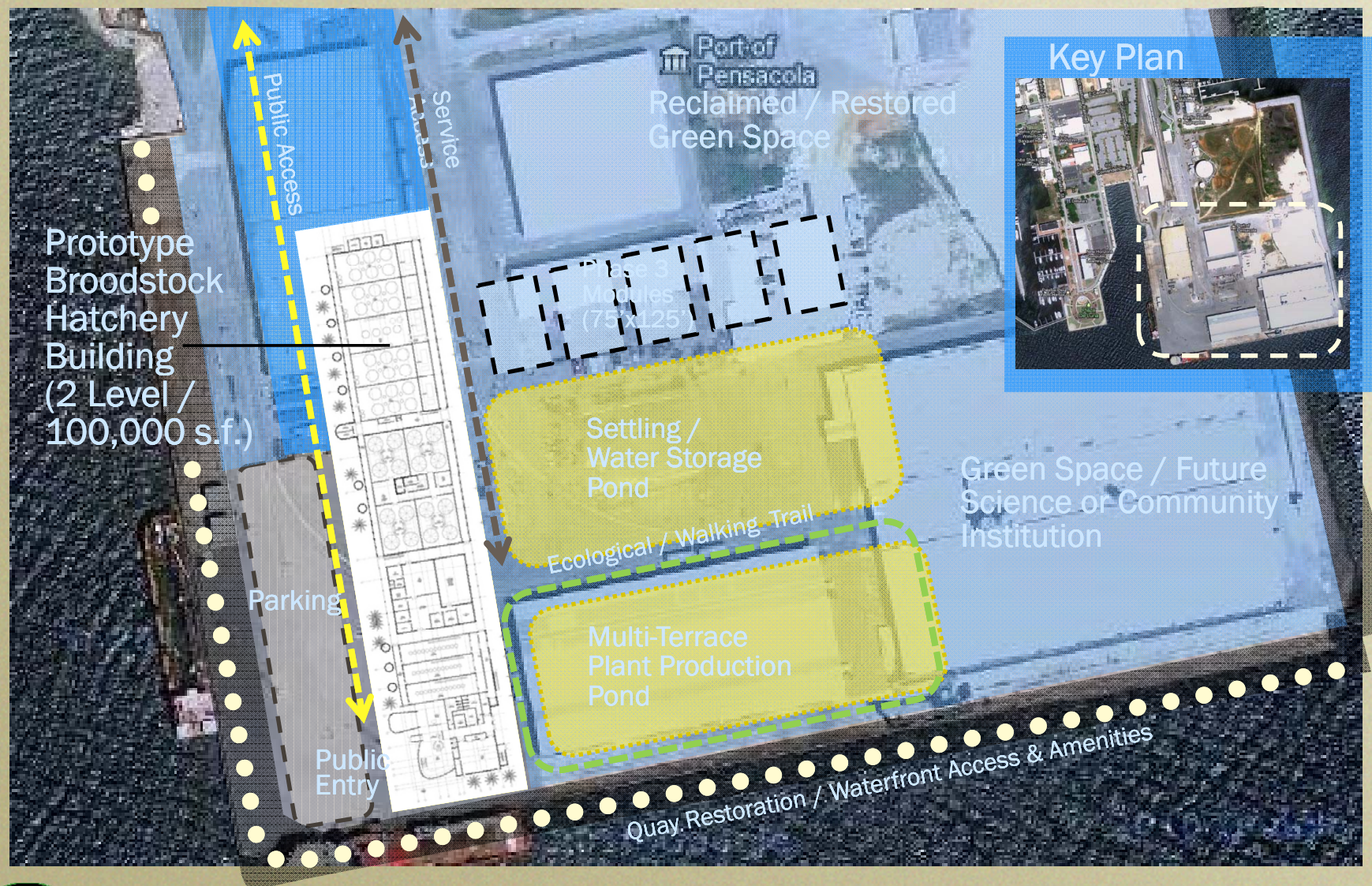
40 tank RAS and
20 tank RAS footprints





Fish and Wildlife Conservation Commission
Nick Wiley, Executive Director

Pensacola Bay Preliminary Site Diagram



FFWCC / Wildlife Foundation of Florida
Prototype Marine Hatchery